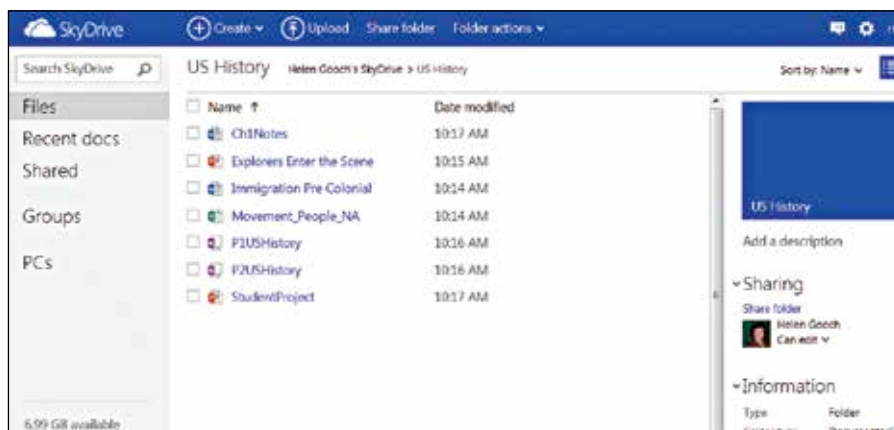
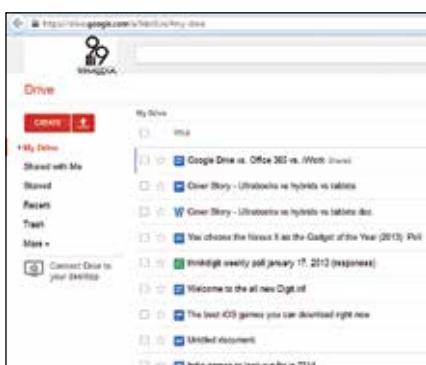




SkyDrive allows you to both save files to a local folder and also view them online



Google Drive also allows you to either save files to a local folder or directly save them online.

this is without any Office branding and inside Outlook Live, so it's strange that Microsoft would effectively hide this functionality. The SkyDrive app, on the other hand, merely lets you view files and if you want to edit them, then you'll need to install Office Mobile and subscribe to Office 365.

Google Drive makes the entire process simpler by letting you create and work with your files directly on the cloud (through the browser) so that everything is synced instantaneously. Like SkyDrive, you can also install the Drive tool on your PC and then move files to the folder that's created.

iWork uses Apple's iCloud to store files in the cloud. Everything that you create using the iWork tools either on iOS or Mac is automatically saved to the cloud. However, unlike Drive or SkyDrive, you can't directly access the files on your local drive since iCloud does not create a local folder. On the other hand, like Drive, iWork for iCloud lets you create and work with files online

(on the [icloud.com](https://www.icloud.com) webpage through the browser). You can also download any such files to your PC and then work on them using any other compatible productivity suite. However, unless you're using the corresponding Apple app/software to do so, the file won't be automatically synced to iCloud. Result: tie between Drive and Office 365.

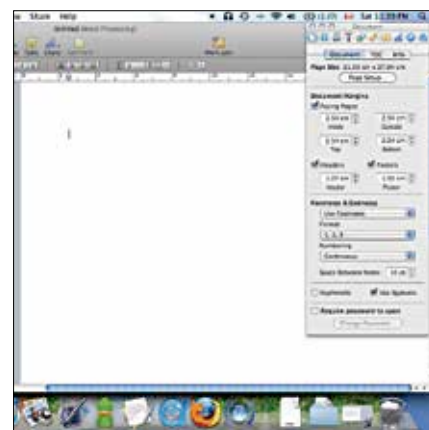
Score: Office365 2 - Drive 2 - iWork 0

Ease of Use

Setting up Office 365 requires you to first subscribe to the service, download it and then install it on your PC. On Windows Phone, you'll need to download and install the Office Mobile app and then sign in using the same ID to be able to use it. Once installed, Office on Windows can be a little overwhelming especially for people who've never used Office before. However, that comes with the territory since Office is, by far, the most powerful productivity suite of the three and therefore, offers a lot more tools and options.

Google Drive is the simplest to use of the lot, if you're only looking to work online. Just open <http://drive.google.com> in the browser where you're logged into your Google account, and you'll immediately see all the files you've worked with. Since the entire suite works online, there's no need to install anything on your machine. The downside is that there's no simple way to work offline. You can set up an offline profile, but in our personal experience, it's quite a buggy mess.

iWork offers a simple enough process to get started. Just install the software/app on your iDevice, log in using your



iWork (Pages shown above) tries to go for a balance between a simple interface and availability of features.

iTunes account and you're good to go. You will see all your files in one place within the corresponding app (Pages, Keynote, Numbers). The actual interface within these apps is quite clean but many will find them shorn of common features, especially if they have some experience with Microsoft Office. Overall, iWork will satisfy users who've previously worked with iWork while others will prefer Drive or Office. Winner? Drive.

Score: Office365 2 - Drive 3 - iWork 0

On the Mobile

Office Mobile for Office 365 is available on iOS, Android and Windows Phone. On Windows Phone, Office Mobile is a fully-functional productivity suite that comes pre-installed on every device. To use Office Mobile on iOS and Android, you will need to have a subscription to Office 365. Office Mobile offers a relatively succinct interface that suits small screens. Like Google Drive, it does not allow you to create PowerPoint presentations. To be able to access your cloud files, you will have to install the SkyDrive app separately.

Google Drive continues its tradition of simplicity in its mobile app as well. You just need to install the Drive app and you're good to go. You can create documents or spreadsheets from within the app itself, as well as browse through your folders and files. The options on offer when creating spreadsheets or documents are quite basic at best even when compared against the apps from Apple and Microsoft.